

39 Predictions and promises

You can talk about future events in English using the verb “will.” This construction has several meanings, which are all different from the future using “going to.”

 **New language** Future tense with “will”

Aa Vocabulary Weather

 **New skill** Making predictions and promises

39.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE FUTURE USING “WILL”

English uses “will” when talking about the future in four main ways:

To make a prediction about what you think will happen.



Wait a few minutes. I think **it will stop** raining soon.

This prediction is not based on evidence.

To offer to do something for someone.



You look frozen. **I'll make** you some hot soup.

To make a promise.



We'll be there by eight. Don't worry!

This decision was not planned in advance.

To describe a decision you've just made.



I know! **I'll buy** Aaron a surfboard for his birthday.

TIP

Remember to use the future with “going to” for predictions based on current evidence, and for decisions made before the time of speaking.



39.2 FILL IN THE GAPS WITH EITHER “WILL” OR “TO BE” WITH “GOING TO”

Zoe 's going to meet Hannah and Ketil in the park this afternoon by the fountain.

- 1 Have a rest, and I _____ cook a warm stew for us to eat tonight.
- 2 I _____ take the dog for a walk after it stops raining, I promise!
- 3 Amelia and Jill _____ buy dresses tomorrow to wear to Tom's birthday party.
- 4 You _____ be cold playing football today. It was snowing this morning!

